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Lewis & Clark Expedition Markers

California (Placer County), Auburn — [Jean Baptiste Charbonneau](#)

As an infant in 1805, he accompanied his parents Toussaint Charbonneau and Sacagawea, as they guided the Lewis & Clark Expedition. He lived along the American River Canyon, at Murderer's, Buckner's, Rattlesnake & Manhattan Bars between 1848 and 1857. In 1861 he worked as a clerk at the Orleans Hotel, located near this site. Died in Oregon shortly after leaving Auburn in 1866. — [Map](#) (db m44067)

California (Sacramento County), Franklin — 657 — [Alexander Hamilton Willard](#)

Born, Charlestown, N.H. Aug. 24, 1778; Died Franklin, Mar. 6, 1865 Last surviving member of the Lewis and Clark Expedition. He kept a journal and gave valuable service as a gunsmith. — [Map](#) (db m10520)

Idaho (Idaho County), Lolo Summit — 247 — [Lolo Summit](#)

The Lewis and Clark party crossed this pass Sept. 13, 1805, westbound for the Pacific after a long detour to the south. From the headwaters of the Missouri they had crossed the mountains to the Salmon. Finding that river impassable, they traded for pack horses, hired an Indian guide, and came north to an Indian trail across the mountains here. Tired and ill-fed, the men were to have a hard struggle in early snow along the steep ridges which the trail followed for most of the 125 mile course west to the Clearwater River. — [Map](#) (db m27120)

Idaho (Nez Perce County), Lewiston — [Lewis and Clark](#)

Lewis and Clark camped on the North Bank of Lewis's or Snake River October 10, 1805 Erected October 1955 by Alice Whitman Chapter D.A.R. — [Map](#) (db m23267)

Illinois (Alexander County), Cairo — ["Proceeding On"](#)

In November, 1803, Meriwether Lewis and William Clark and their growing contingent of "Corps of Discovery" men, spent five days here teaching each other celestial navigation and surveying skills. Using a sextant, octant, artificial horizon, and reference tables, they successfully obtained the first longitude and latitude data that they would use during the Expedition. Subsequent maps of the northern and western portions of the United States, prepared using Lewis and Clark's data, began at the . . . — [Map](#) (db m19393)

Illinois (Alexander County), Cairo — [Historical Survey Marker](#)

The beginning of the Third Principal Meridian is located in the Ohio River 1,735 feet directly north of this point. In November, 1803, this was the mouth of the Ohio River. At this location, the Lewis and Clark Corps of Discovery encamped for six days. — [Map](#) (db m19415)

Illinois (Alexander County), Cairo — [Lewis & Clark](#) — *Corps of Discovery*

Charting the Confluence On November 14, 1803, at the confluence of the Ohio and Mississippi Rivers, the Corps of Discovery stayed for six days, one of the longest stops made by the expedition. Here, they saw the Mississippi for the first time, noted the mistletoe on the large timber and to their surprise, caught a 128 pound blue catfish. Their stay allowed Captain Lewis to teach Captain Clark the use of the navigational equipment; a compass and sextant. Because the 3rd Principal Meridian . . . — [Map](#) (db m19413)

Illinois (Alexander County), Cairo — [Lewis and Clark in Illinois](#)

On November 14, 1803, Meriwether Lewis, William Clark and their party landed at the confluence of the Ohio and Mississippi Rivers, the site of the present day Cairo. They spent nearly a week here, learning how to determine longitude and latitude, a skill they would need on their westward expedition. — [Map](#) (db m19419)

Illinois (Alexander County), Cairo — [The Beginning of the Third Principal Meridian](#)

The beginning of the Third Principal Meridian is located in the Ohio River 1,810 feet directly north of this point. In November, 1803, this was the mouth of the Ohio River. At this location, the Lewis & Clark Corps of Discovery encamped for six days. — [Map](#) (db m19420)

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Illinois (Alexander County), Cairo — [York the Slave](#)

York was the first known African American to cross the American continent. In the company of Lewis and Clark Corps of Discovery, from 1803-1806, he shared equally with them the rigors of the journey, but when the corps was honored, he received no recognition. Whenever the corps came upon American Indian tribes, however, his uniqueness became apparent. To the Crow, York's blackness of skin was viewed as "big medicine," to the Shoshonis and Nez Perce, he was a man of curiosity and strength and . . . — [Map](#) (db m41063)

Illinois (Madison County), Alton — [Lewis and Clark Expedition](#)

Near here at Camp Dubois, the Lewis and Clark Detachment spent the winter of 1803. They left on May 14, 1804, ascending the Missouri River to its source. Crossed the Great Divide reaching the Pacific on November 7, 1805. They returned to Illinois on September 23, 1806 having concluded one of the most dramatic and significant events in our history. — [Map](#) (db m2514)

Illinois (Madison County), Alton — [The Journey Begins Here](#)

Meriwether Lewis and William Clark of the Corps of Discovery stayed at Camp River Dubois during the winter of 1803–1804, on their journey to find an all-water-route to the Pacific Ocean. For five months, the Corps stayed near the confluence of the Mississippi and Missouri Rivers, training and preparing for the long journey ahead. On May 14, 1804 the expedition traveled up the Missouri River during their journey to the Pacific Ocean. This area has seen many changes since 1804. Imagine . . . — [Map](#) (db m2400)

Indiana (Harrison County), Corydon — 31.2004.1 — [John Shields](#) — *Lewis and Clark Expedition Member*

[Marker Front]: Shields, born 1769 in Virginia, served as a private for the entire Lewis and Clark Expedition from October 19, 1803 until October 10, 1806; one of its "Nine Young Men from Kentucky," he was a skilled gunsmith and blacksmith. *[Marker Reverse]:* The Corps of Discovery explored lands of Louisiana Purchase and Pacific Northwest, 1803 - 1806. Shields settled in southern Indiana by June 1807; appointed captain in Clark County militia July 1807. Died in Harrison County in December 1809. — [Map](#) (db m9642)

Indiana (Knox County), Vincennes — 42.2006.1 — [William Henry Harrison - & - Lewis & Clark Expedition](#) — Expedition Contact Person

Side One Harrison became Governor of Indiana Territory 1800; he administered government of District of Louisiana 1804-1805. In Vincennes, he served as a contact during the expedition; surviving records document his support and his involvement in decisions about western Indian chiefs visiting Washington. *Side Two* In 1806, on their way to the Falls of the Ohio and then Washington after the expedition, Lewis and Clark stopped in Vincennes; Lewis wrote from Vincennes on . . . — [Map](#) (db m23251)

Indiana (Montgomery County), Waynetown — 54-2002-1 — [William Bratton](#) — *Lewis and Clark Expedition Member*

(Obverse): Bratton (1779 - 1841) is buried in this cemetery. With U.S. Army rank of private, he joined Lewis and Clark Expedition's Corps of Discovery near Clarksville, Indiana 1803. Corps explored lands of Louisiana Purchase and Pacific Northwest. *(Reverse):* Bratton's duties included hunter, blacksmith, saltmaker. He completed entire journey; discharged October 10, 1806. Settled on farm in Wayne Township 1822; held various county and township offices, including Justice of the Peace. — [Map](#) (db m3868)

Iowa (Pottawattamie County), Council Bluffs — [Seeking Buyers and Sellers](#)

French, Spanish, and British traders already controlled trade empires west of the Mississippi river when Lewis and Clark began the Expedition in 1804. but President Thomas Jefferson wanted the United States to control trade in the newly acquired Louisiana Purchase.

First, many questions had to be answered: Is it true there is a direct water route to the Pacific Ocean? Are there minerals to mine? Where are good locations for towns, farmers, and military forts? Conducting this research was an . . . — [Map](#) (db m45162)

Iowa (Pottawattamie County), Council Bluffs — [We Were All Busily Engaged](#)

After traveling 68 days and 600 miles, it was time for the Corps of discovery to stop for a rest. On July 22, 1804, William Clark wrote, they camped on the east side of the Missouri River, about 10 miles above the mouth of the Platte River, on land "covered with timbers of oak, walnut and elm."

Patrick Gass, expedition carpenter, described in his journal how the crew spent their five days near here. "Our people were all busily engaged in hunting, making oars, dressing . . . — [Map](#) (db m45164)

Iowa (Pottawattamie County), Crescent — [Anticipating An Indian Council](#)

One of President Jefferson's goals for this expedition was to seek out the native peoples and council with

Native Americans
Natural Disasters
Natural Features
Natural Resources
Notable Buildings
Notable Events
Notable Persons
Notable Places
Paleontology
Patriots & Patriotism
Peace
Political
Subdivisions
Politics
Railroads & Streetcars
Roads & Vehicles
Science & Medicine
Settlements & Settlers
Sports
War of 1812
War, 1st Iraq & Desert Storm
War, 2nd Iraq
War, Afghanistan
War, Cold
War, English Civil
War, French and Indian
War, Korean
War, Mexican-American
War, Spanish-American
War, Texas Independence
War, US Civil
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them. On July 28, 2804, the expedition passed this overlook area early in the morning and noted of this area "a bluff on the S.S. (Starboard Side), the first high land above the Nodaway (river) on that side." They observed a site below these bluffs where the "Aiawuay (Iowa) Indians formerly lived" and had just passed another old Indian camp downstream on the other . . . — [Map](#) (db m45111)

Iowa (Pottawattamie County), Crescent — [Like a Bald Man's Head](#)

During late July and early August of 1804, the Lewis and Clark Expedition traveled the length of the Missouri River that today is the boarder between Iowa and Nebraska. Meriwether Lewis and William Clark studied the river, forests, and prairies. They often hiked along the riverbanks and explored inland while other crew members kept the keelboat and pirogues moving upriver. Clark described the river bluffs and tall grass prairie in his journal. He compared the bluffs to the head of a bald man, . . . — [Map](#) (db m45117)

Iowa (Pottawattamie County), Crescent — [The Lewis and Clark Expedition](#)

In 1804-06, Captains Meriwether Lewis and William Clark led about 40 soldiers and boatmen on an epic journey. President Thomas Jefferson commissioned this "Corps of discovery" to find a route to the Pacific Ocean through the newly acquired Louisiana territory. Along the way, they mapped the land, recorded its resources, and contacted its native inhabitants. The landscape has changed since Lewis and Clark explored it: rivers have been dammed, forests cut over, prairies plowed under, . . . — [Map](#) (db m45116)

Kansas (Atchison County), Atchison — ["the water...contains a half...Glass of ooze"](#)

"The water we drink or the Common water of the missourie at this time, contains a half a Comm Wine Glass of ooze or mud to every pint-" William Clark June 21, 1804 The Missouri River of Lewis and Clark's era was wild and unpredictable. It earned the nickname "Big Muddy" due to the abundance of sand, sediment, silt, and clay. In a constant state of change, the river cut side channels, chutes, eddies, boils, sandbars, backwaters, and oxbows - strong currents in some places, slow in . . . — [Map](#) (db m44801)

Kansas (Atchison County), Atchison — ["walked on Shore above this Creek"](#)

"...Capt. Lewis walked on Shore above this Creek and discovered a high moun from the top of which he had an extensive view, 3 paths Concentering at the moun..." William Clark July 4, 1804 The U.S. Army expedition led by Captains Meriwether Lewis and William Clark paused here on July 4, 1804. It is possible that the mound that Clark described is the bluff that rises above this site. In his journal, Captain Clark enumerated the members of the expedition, concluding with: "1 Corpl & . . . — [Map](#) (db m44812)

Kansas (Atchison County), Atchison — [4th of July, 1804 Creek](#)

July 4, 1804 William Clark recorded in his journal that on this date, the Corps of Discovery "Passed a Creek 12 yrs. wide...coming out of an extensive Prarie reching within 200 yeards of the river, as this Creek has no name, and this being the...the [sic] 4th of July the day of the independence of the U.S. call it...4th of July 1804 Creek" — [Map](#) (db m44786)

Kansas (Atchison County), Atchison — [Lewis Discovers a High Mound](#)

July 4, 1804 William Clark recorded in his journal that on this date: "Capt. Lewis walked on Shore above this Creek and discovered a high moun[d] from the top of which he had an extensive view, 3 paths Concentering at the moun[d]" — [Map](#) (db m44794)

Kansas (Atchison County), Atchison — [The Bridge Over 4th of July 1804 Creek](#)

This stream was named by Meriwether Lewis and William Clark when they stopped at the present site of Atchison, Kansas on July 4, 1804. The following is an excerpt from Clark's logbook: "...as this creek has no name, and this being the 4th of July, the day of the Independence of the U.S., call it 4th of July 1804 Creek..." - William Clark Dedicated July 4, 1996 — [Map](#) (db m44784)

Kansas (Atchison County), Atchison — [The Lewis and Clark Expedition](#)

In 1804-06, Captains Meriwether Lewis and William Clark led about 40 soldiers and boatmen on an epic journey. President Thomas Jefferson commissioned this "Corps of Discovery" to find a route to the Pacific Ocean through the newly acquired Louisiana territory. Along the way, they mapped the land, recorded its resources, and contacted its native inhabitants. The landscape has changed since Lewis and Clark explored it: rivers have been dammed, forests cut over, prairies plowed under, and . . . — [Map](#) (db m44807)

Kentucky (Ballard County), Wickliffe — [Lewis & Clark at Old Fort Jefferson](#)

Long before Lewis and Clark stopped near Wickliffe in western Kentucky on their outbound trip to the west, Fort Jefferson had been built in 1780-81 by George Rogers Clark during the Revolutionary War as an outpost against British-led Indian attacks. It was also constructed to project the claim of the infant United States to a western boundary on the Mississippi River. Decommissioned within a year, records have been located detailing the day-to-day activities of those who lived in the fort or . . . — [Map](#) (db m18548)

Kentucky (Bell County), Middlesboro — 2217 — [Lewis and Clark in Kentucky Cumberland Gap](#) —

- Arkansas
- British Columbia
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- Connecticut
- Delaware
- District of Columbia
- Florida
- Georgia
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- Idaho
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Cumberland Gap

Side A: Meriwether Lewis, coleader of the Lewis & Clark Expedition, with a party of Expedition veterans and a Mandan Indian delegation, went through Cumberland Gap in Nov. 1806 en route to Washington to report on the expedition. *(Over) Side B:* Cumberland Gap Expedition coleader William Clark traveled through the Gap in Dec. 1806 on his way to Washington to reunite with Lewis and to report to President Thomas Jefferson and other government officials about the journey. — [Map](#) (db m33299)

Maryland (Frederick County), Bolivar — [John Collins](#)

Native of Frederick County, skilled hunter and a superintendent of provisions with the Lewis and Clark expedition, John Collins was the first Marylander to cross the North American continent. Meriwether Lewis and William Clark were charged by Thomas Jefferson to lead an expedition to find a water route to the Pacific. From 1804 to 1806 the Corps of Discovery traveled 8,000 miles as they documented their encounters with inhabitants, identified natural resources and mapped the interior of western North America. — [Map](#) (db m1904)

Missouri, St. Louis — [Lewis and Clark and St. Louis Riverfront](#)

The Return of the Lewis and Clark Expedition Michael Haynes "We Arrived in Sight of St. Louis" At about noon on September 23, 1806, five dugout canoes and a larger boat called the "White Pirogue" rounded the bend of the Mississippi River to the north of where you are standing. The citizens of St. Louis, perhaps numbering as many as 1,500, lined the riverbank atop the natural bluff, cheering and firing guns into the air to welcome back Lewis and Clark's "Corps of Discovery."

After . . . — [Map](#) (db m40810)

Missouri (Buchanan County), Iatan — [Wetland Habitats of the Past](#) — *Little Bean Marsh Conservation Area* — The Journey of Lewis & Clark

July 4th Wednesday (1804) ...proceeded on, passed the mouth of a Bayeau lading from a large Lake on the S.S. which has the appearance of being once the bed of the river & reaches parrelel for several Miles... William Clark Traveling up the Missouri River, Lewis and Clark found a complex river snaking its way from bluff to bluff. The river overflowed into backwaters and sloughs and refreshed the miles of marshes and wetlands bordering its path. Little Bean Marsh is an example of . . . — [Map](#) (db m44569)

Missouri (Buchanan County), Lewis and Clark State Park — [Lewis and Clark in Missouri](#)

Missouri was a beginning and end for the Lewis and Clark Expedition. Planned by President Thomas Jefferson and carried out by the two captains and a large crew, the expedition is a keystone American event. When the United States took ownership of the Louisiana Territory - during a ceremony in St. Louis in March 1804 probably attended by Meriwether Lewis and William Clark - the country doubled in size, and expansion to the Pacific Ocean seemed possible. Two months later, the "Corps of . . . — [Map](#) (db m44590)

Missouri (Buchanan County), Lewis and Clark State Park — [The Lewis and Clark Expedition Across Missouri](#)

The land that would become Missouri and 14 other western states was acquired by the United States in the greatest land acquisition in American history: the Louisiana Purchase. By the stroke of a pen, President Thomas Jefferson ensured the country would be a continental power, reaching from the Atlantic toward the Pacific Ocean. For about three cents an acre, the United States nearly doubled its size, gaining almost 830,000 square miles from the Mississippi River to the Rocky Mountains, and . . . — [Map](#) (db m44615)

Missouri (Buchanan County), Lewis and Clark State Park — [The Lewis and Clark Expedition Across Missouri](#)

"Groops of Shrubs covered with the most delicious froot is to be seen in every direction, and nature appears to have exerted herself to butify the Senery by the variety of flours [flowers] Delicately and highly flavored raised above the Grass, which Strikes & profumes the Sensation, and amuses the mind." William Clark, July 4, 1804 Although the boats were past the hardest stretch of the Missouri River - between the Grand and Kansas rivers - travel was by no means easy, thanks to the . . . — [Map](#) (db m44624)

Missouri (Buchanan County), Saint Joseph — [St. Michael's Prairie / The Lewis and Clark Expedition](#)

St. Michael's Prairie St. Michael's Prairie, the site where St. Joseph would be established, was identified on maps at least as early as 1792. French explorers and trappers had been traveling up and down the Missouri River since the early 1700s, and many areas along the river had been used as camps or temporary settlements. St. Michael was the name of a French family whose history is linked with the Mississippi and Missouri Rivers, so it is possible that during the 18th century this area . . . — [Map](#) (db m47472)

Missouri (Clay County), Liberty — [The Lewis and Clark Expedition Across Missouri](#)

"The Deer in the Morning & evening are feeding in great numbers on the banks of the River, they feed on young willow, and amuse themselves running on the open beeches or points." William Clark, June 25, 1804.

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The Lewis and Clark Expedition passed this location on June 25, 1804. That morning a heavy fog delayed the departure of the expedition from the campsite of the previous day, which was near present-day Atherton. The river was running high but was just beginning to . . . — [Map](#) (db m46351)

Missouri (Jackson County), Kansas City — [Lewis and Clark Expedition Across Missouri](#)

"we Set out early... Passed the mouth of ... Blue water river...[and later]... a bad Sand bar, where our two rope twice.... Came to and Camped in the Point above the Kansas River. I observed a great number of Parrot queets this evening..." William Clark, June 26, 1804 On June 26, 1804, the Lewis and Clark Expedition arrived at the mouth of the Kansas River. Throughout the day on June 26, the men of the Corps of Discovery often had to tow the keelboat and the two pirogues that . . . — [Map](#) (db m26783)

Missouri (Jackson County), Kansas City — [The French and the Lewis & Clark Expedition](#) — *Les Français et l'Expedition de Lewis et Clark*

Marker Front: The French-speaking community made a significant contribution to the ultimate success of the epochal Lewis & Clark expedition. The St. Louis Chouteau brothers, fur traders Auguste and Pierre, lodged the two captains in their substantial homes many times during the winter of 1803-04, and assisted in procuring supplies, boats, and personnel. Pierre acted as a downstream agent and post office for the expedition. French voyageurs had ventured up the Missouri for over a . . . — [Map](#) (db m26719)

Missouri (Marion County), Palmyra — [George Shannon](#) — *1787-1836*

This marker commemorates George Shannon, the youngest member of the Corps of Discovery, on the occasion of the bicentennial of the Lewis and Clark Expedition. He died in Palmyra, Missouri while on legal business, August 30, 1836, and is buried one mile north of Palmyra in the Massey Mill Cemetery. Marker dedicated on June 13, 2004 by the Missouri State Society DAR and the Hannibal Heritage Chapter DAR. — [Map](#) (db m30416)

Missouri (Platte County), Iatan — [Cow Island](#)

"Set out verry early this morning and proceeded on under a gentle Breeze from the S. passed two Islands one a Small Willow Island on the L.S. the other large Called by the french Isle de Vache or Cow Island, opposit the head of the S.S. is a large Pond containg Beever, & fowl" This is part of Captain Clark's July 3rd journal entry. The land between you and the present-day river was Cow Island, so named because French traders kept cows on the island in the 1700s. Cow Island was where the . . . — [Map](#) (db m44567)

Missouri (Platte County), Iatan — [The Lewis and Clark Expedition](#)

In 1804-06, Captains Meriwether Lewis and William Clark led about 40 soldiers and boatmen on an epic journey. President Thomas Jefferson commissioned this "Corps of Discovery" to find a route to the Pacific Ocean through the newly acquired Louisiana territory. Along the way, they mapped the land, recorded its resources, and contacted its native inhabitants. The landscape has changed since Lewis and Clark explored it: rivers have been dammed, forests cut over, prairies plowed under, and . . . — [Map](#) (db m44565)

Missouri (Platte County), Kansas City — C7 — [Lewis and Clark](#)

In 1803, only a handful of states existed in America – the rest of the land was uncharted wilderness. That wilderness included the Louisiana Territory, which was purchased that year by the United States government. At the same time, President Thomas Jefferson received approval from Congress for one of the most exciting exploration projects in history – to find a passage to the Pacific Ocean following the Missouri and Columbia Rivers. Two adventurers, Meriwether Lewis and William . . . — [Map](#) (db m43233)

Missouri (Platte County), Weston — [The Lewis and Clark Expedition](#)

In 1804-06, Captains Meriwether Lewis and William Clark led about 40 soldiers and boatmen on an epic journey. President Thomas Jefferson commissioned this "Corps of Discovery" to find a route to the Pacific Ocean through the newly acquired Louisiana territory. Along the way, they mapped the land, recorded its resources, and contacted its native inhabitants. The landscape has changed since Lewis and Clark explored it: rivers have been dammed, forests cut over, prairies plowed under, and . . . — [Map](#) (db m44517)

Montana (Gallatin County), Bozeman — [First People in the Gallatin Valley](#) — *To the Headwaters*

For centuries distant and diverse tribes visited the Gallatin Valley to hunt. They stampeded buffalo over cliffs during the "dog days" before the acquisition of horses and guns. They hunted animals for food, clothing and shelter. They also mined chert to make projectile points. The Minnitaree tribe of North Dakota captured Sacagawea in this valley in 1800. She and her trapper husband, Toussaint Charbonneau, joined the Lewis and Clark Expedition as interpreters. Sacagawea proved invaluable . . . — [Map](#) (db m29075)

Montana (Gallatin County), Bozeman — [Fort Ellis](#) — *To the Headwaters*

Conflicts along the Bozeman Trail between Lakota, Northern Cheyenne, and Arapaho Indians and settlers escalated with the establishment of forts along the route in 1866. After Indians killed John Bozeman, in the Yellowstone Valley in 1867, the federal government established Fort Ellis in the Gallatin Valley that same year.

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For the next two decades, soldiers from the 13th Infantry and the 2nd Cavalry manned this post, participating in battles at the Little Bighorn in 1876 and the Big Hole in . . . — [Map](#) (db m29079)

Montana (Gallatin County), Bozeman — [Fur Trade](#) — *To the Headwaters*

An abundance of beaver encouraged Corps of Discovery members John Colter and John Potts to return to the headwaters. In 1808, Blackfeet Indians killed Potts in a confrontation and stripped Colter bare, giving him a chance to run for his life. In one of the most famous foot races in American history, he outran his armed pursuers and escaped to the Madison River where he hid in a beaver lodge. Ten days and 200 miles later, Colter miraculously straggled into Fort Ramon near present day Custer, . . . — [Map](#) (db m29077)

Montana (Gallatin County), Bozeman — [Lewis and Clark](#) — *To the Headwaters*

Lewis and Clark's Corps of Discovery reached the headwaters of the Missouri River and named the three tributaries in July, 1805. With great difficulty the Corps of Discovery fought rapids and troublesome mosquitoes as they pulled their boats upstream to the west. On their return trip in 1806, Expedition members separated at Travelers Rest near Lolo, Montana. Capt. Lewis and nine men headed east to Great Falls, while Clark and the rest of the party, along with 50 horses, returned to the . . . — [Map](#) (db m29072)

Montana (Gallatin County), Bozeman — [Trail Through Time](#) — *To the Headwaters*

First Peoples utilized the valley for over 11,000 years before the arrival of Lewis & Clark, and the others that would follow. Trails brought cattle and homesteaders to an agricultural paradise. The military followed, defending settlers, consuming local products and mounting expeditions into the Yellowstone. The railroad brought material goods and tied the region to the national economy. Over 11,000 years ago The First Peoples moving into North America across an ice age land bridge came . . . — [Map](#) (db m29084)

Montana (Sweet Grass County), Greycliff — [Captain Wm. Clark](#)

You are now following the historic trail of the Lewis and Clark Expedition. On his return from the Pacific in July 1806, Captain Clark camped for six days about forty miles downstream, near Park City. The Expedition had been looking for timber suitable for building canoes ever since striking the river near Livingston. They found a couple of large cottonwoods here that would serve. They fitted their axes with handles made from chokecherry and went to work making two canoes. When finished they . . . — [Map](#) (db m28948)

Nebraska (Douglas County), Omaha — 428 — [Captain William Clark and Private Reuben Field](#)

On July 27, 1804, Lewis and Clark's Corps of Discovery left their "White Catfish" camp and proceeded up the Missouri River. After traveling some distance, Clark "took one man R. Field and walked on Shore with a View of Examining Som mounds" on the Nebraska side. He found the mounds "of Deffirent hight Shape & Size, Som Composed of Sand Some earth & sand....all of which covered about 200 acres." The mounds may have been the remains of earthlodges, which served . . . — [Map](#) (db m32964)

Nebraska (Douglas County), Omaha — 340 — [Lewis and Clark Campsite](#) — *July 27, 1804*

At the camp established very near here Captain Clark wrote about the "butifull Breeze from the N W. this evening which would have been verry agreeable, had the Misqueters been tolerably Pacifick, but thy were raging all night." Clark may have exaggerated when he noted that the mosquitoes were as big as house flies. They would continue to plague the explorers until winter. That evening Clark and Ruben Fields "walked on Shore with a View of examoning Som mounds." Although the mounds were . . . — [Map](#) (db m7886)

Nebraska (Washington County), Blair — 342 — [Lewis and Clark Campsites](#) — *August 3 and 4, 1804*

On August 3 Lewis and Clark held a council with the Oto and Missouri Indians at a site they named "Council Bluff," near present Fort Calhoun, Nebraska. It was the first of many councils they would hold on their journey to the Pacific Ocean. Following the council, the explorers moved upriver, camping south of today's community of Blair. Besides describing the council, Clark's journal notes the merits of "Council Bluff" as a location for "a Trading establishment & fortification." In 1819 the . . . — [Map](#) (db m7794)

Nebraska (Washington County), Fort Calhoun — 341 — [Lewis and Clark Campsite](#) — *July 30 - August 2, 1804*

On July 30 the explorers arrived at the bluff where Fort Atkinson would be built less than two decades later. Clark wrote, "The Situation of this place which we Call Council Bluff which is handsom ellevated a Spot well Calculated... for a fort to Command the Countrey and river the low bottom above high water & well Situated under the Command of the Hill for Houses to trade with the Natives." Four days later the Oto Indians, who lived in a village along the Platte River, came to the Lewis . . . — [Map](#) (db m7887)

North Carolina (Franklin County), Louisburg — E 33 — [Richard Warfington](#)

Member of Lewis and Clark Expedition, 1804-06. Led the return trip from Mandan villages. Born 1777 near here. — [Map](#) (db m41128)

North Dakota (McLean County), Washburn — [Seaman](#)

While preparing for the expedition to the Pacific, Meriwether Lewis visited Philadelphia for instructions in natural sciences, astronomical navigation and field medicine. It is believed that it was during this period that Lewis purchased Seaman, his *"dogg of the Newfoundland breed,"* for \$20. Although Lewis left unsaid his reason for selecting a Newfoundland, he may have been impressed with the breed's size, strength and swimming abilities and its reputation for having a keen . . . — [Map](#) (db m36352)

North Dakota (Mercer County), Stanton — [Lewis & Clark at the Knife River Indian Villages](#) — *Lewis & Clark in North Dakota*

With 168 days and 1,600 miles behind them, the Lewis and Clark Expedition arrived near the Knife River Villages. Captain William Clark wrote: October 27, 1804 *"came too at the Village on the L.S. this village is situated on an eminence of about 50 feet above the Water in a handsome plain it contains [40 or 50] houses in a kind of Picket work, the houses are round and verry large containing several families, as also their horses which is tied on one Side of the . . .* — [Map](#) (db m33610)

North Dakota (Morton County), Mandan — [Mandan Scenic Overlook](#) — *Lewis & Clark in North Dakota*

Sunday, October 21, 1804 A driving northeast wind, cold temperatures, and freezing rain and snow led Lewis and Clark to seek shelter after only 7 miles. During the day, they passed the mouth of the Heart River learning from their Arikara passenger that the Mandans had sacred sites in that area. Several other abandoned earth lodge villages were reported, including one located in *"a butifull & extensive plain."* Clark killed a buffalo near their campsite northeast of modern Mandan on the west bank of the river. — [Map](#) (db m44707)

Ohio (Washington County), Marietta — 14-84 — [Lewis and Clark Expedition / Letter to the President](#)

[Marker Front]: The Lewis and Clark Expedition Meriwether Lewis arrived in Marietta on September 13, 1803. His descent of the Ohio River aboard a keelboat began his expedition to explore the West. Included among his crew was 18-year old George Shannon of Barnesville, the only member of the Corps of Discovery known to have been from Ohio. While in Marietta, Lewis wrote a letter to President Thomas Jefferson. In updating his journal, he wrote,"This evening was visited by Colo. . . . — [Map](#) (db m20741)

Oregon (Columbia County), Deer Island — M1 — [Deer Island](#) — *Oregon History*

Deer Island in the Columbia was named by the Lewis and Clark Expedition which stopped to dine here November 5, 1805 on its way down river. Homeward bound the explorers camped on the island on March 28,1806. Captain Clark recorded "This morning we set out very early and at 9 a.m. arrived at an old Indian village on NE side of Deer Island where we found our hunters had halted and left one man with the canoes at their camp. They arrived last evening and six of them turned out very early to hunt, . . . — [Map](#) (db m7981)

Oregon (Multnomah County), Cascade Locks — [Beacon Rock](#)

The prominent monolith across the river was named Beacon Rock by Lewis and Clark, November 2, 1805. It marked the beginning of tidewater for early river explorers who used it for a landmark in their journeys. The Indians say that when the Chinook winds blow softly up the river one can hear the wailings of unhappy, beautiful Wahatpolitan, the Indian maid who climbed the rock and perished with her child, when given to a chief other than the one she loved. — [Map](#) (db m34643)

Oregon (Multnomah County), Troutdale — [Sandy River Bridge](#)

On October 30, 1792 off the point in the Columbia River where the Sandy empties its waters, the boat crew from the H.M.S. Chatham (Vancouver's Voyages) were the first white men to sight the snowclad peak which Lt. Wm. R. Broughton named Mt. Hood in honor of Vice Admiral Samuel Lord Hood of the British Navy. He called the stream Barings River. Later in November 1805 Lewis and Clark called it the Quicksand River. Still later by common use it became known as Sandy River. — [Map](#) (db m38388)

Pennsylvania (Allegheny County), Pittsburgh — [Lewis & Clark Expedition](#)

On Aug. 31, 1803, Capt. Meriwether Lewis launched a 50-foot "keeled boat" from Ft. Fayette, 100 yards downriver. This marked the beginning of the 3-year expedition commissioned by President Jefferson, which opened America to westward expansion. — [Map](#) (db m42181)

Pennsylvania (Beaver County), Rochester — [Lewis and Clark](#)

In 1803, Meriwether Lewis led the corps of discovery, 11 men on a keelboat, though Beaver County. They stayed overnight about 3 miles west of Beaver and stopped in Georgetown. This visit was commemorated by a reenactment in Rochester and Georgetown in 2003. — [Map](#) (db m44791)

South Dakota (Clay County), Vermillion — [From Lewis and Clark to the Future](#)

Change came slowly to Spirit Mound after 1804. For 55 years the area remained the land of the Yankton Sioux, with fur traders conducting business from posts on the Missouri. The tallgrass prairie continued to

thrive as it had for thousands of years before. In 1859 the Yankton moved to a reservation 70 miles upriver, and Congress created Dakota Territory in 1861.

The first homestead was filed on Spirit Mound in 1868. A pioneer recalled that looking north from the top of the mound, he . . . — [Map](#) (db m39702)

South Dakota (Clay County), Vermillion — [Lewis and Clark Visit Spirit Mound](#) — *August 25, 1804*

On the hot day of August 25, 1804, captains Lewis and Clark and several of their men walked from the river to explore Spirit Mound. They had heard that little people with deadly arrows inhabited the mound. Although they did not find little people, they saw their big herds of buffalo as well as elk, burrows of either badgers or "Prairie Wolves" (coyotes), meadowlarks, swallows, and the first bat they had seen on the expedition. Suffering from heat and thirst, they walked back to the . . . — [Map](#) (db m39698)

South Dakota (Clay County), Vermillion — [Lewis and Clark Were Here...and Here...](#)

The Missouri National Recreational River preserves two splendid segments of the free-flowing, once unpredictable "Big Muddy." These natural-appearing reaches are reminiscent of the river as reported in the journal pages of captains Lewis and Clark and four other members of the Corps of Discovery.

Change is a constant. And much has changed along the Corps of Discovery's route since "Mr. Lewis' Tour" first traveled through the middle Missouri region two centuries ago. Both human and natural . . . — [Map](#) (db m39701)

South Dakota (Clay County), Vermillion — [Spirit Mound](#)

This trail leads to the summit of Spirit Mound, a sacred site for several Plains Indian tribes. Some tribal members make pilgrimages to Spirit Mound, say prayers on top, and leave offerings. As you approach and walk to the top, please do so respectfully.

On clear days, the summit offers views as far away as the Big Sioux River to the southeast, the James River to the west, and the Nebraska Bluffs to the south. Before starting out on this 0.8-mile trail to the summit, be aware that there . . . — [Map](#) (db m39700)

Tennessee (Lewis County), Hohenwald — [Meriwether Lewis](#) — *1774-1809*

Beneath this monument erected under Legislative Act by the State of Tennessee, A.D., 1848, reposes the dust of Meriwether Lewis, a Captain in the United States Army, Private Secretary to President Jefferson, Senior Commander of the Lewis and Clark Expedition, and Governor of the Territory of Louisiana. In the Grinder house, the ruins of which are still discernible, 230 yards south of this spot. His life of romantic endeavor and lasting achievement came tragically and mysteriously to its . . . — [Map](#) (db m36068)

Virginia (Albemarle County), Charlottesville — W-199 — [Clark's Birthplace](#)

A mile north was born George Rogers Clark, defender of Kentucky and conqueror of the Northwest, November 19, 1752. — [Map](#) (db m17271)

Virginia (Albemarle County), Ivy — W-161 — [Birthplace of Meriwether Lewis](#)

Half a mile north was born, 1774, Meriwether Lewis, of the Lewis and Clark Expedition, sent by Jefferson to explore the far west, 1804–1806. The expedition reached the mouth of the Columbia River, November 15, 1805. — [Map](#) (db m1795)

Washington (Franklin County), Pasco — [Sacagawea](#)

The Lewis and Clark Expedition camped nearby on October 16 and 17, 1805 on its way to the Pacific Ocean. One of the members of the Expedition was a young Northern Shoshone, Sacagawea.

During the winter of 1804-05 at Fort Mandan, in present-day North Dakota , Captains Meriwether Lewis and William Clark hired Sacagawea's French-Canadian husband, Toussaint Charbonneau, as an interpreter. Sacagawea would accompany him as the Expedition's "interpreters," as termed in the . . . — [Map](#) (db m38587)

West Virginia (Brooke County), Wellsburg — [Patrick Gass](#) — *1771-1870*

Sergeant on the Lewis and Clark Expedition, he published the first account of that exploration in 1807. Veteran of the War of 1812, he fought in the Battle of Lundy's Lane and at Fort Erie. Citizen of Wellsburg for more than half a century, he married and raised his family on Grog Run and Pierce's Run. He is now buried in Brooke County Cemetery. The bust of Patrick Gass as a young man on the Lewis and Clark Expedition was sculpted by Agnes Vincen Talbot of . . . — [Map](#) (db m21629)

West Virginia (Brooke County), Wellsburg — [The Lewis and Clark Connection](#)

The Corps of Discovery, under the command of Meriwether Lewis and William Clark, was the first official expedition through the interior of the North American Continent sponsored by the United States. Captain Meriwether Lewis passed Charles Town in Virginia (later renamed Wellsburg) on September 7, 1803. Lewis

brought the expedition's keelboat down the Ohio River to rendezvous with William Clark near Louisville, Kentucky. The expedition spent the winter of 1803-04 at a camp located . . . — [Map](#) (db m21639)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — 5 — [Armory Grounds](#) — Meriwether Lewis at Harpers Ferry

The United States Armory was the main reason Lewis came to Harpers Ferry. He needed dependable weapons and supplies to succeed on his mission. The quality of the armorers' handiwork would also mean the difference between life and death for Lewis and his men. In 1803, the armory consisted of ten buildings. Their foundations are upstream and underneath the existing railroad embankment. — [Map](#) (db m20481)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — 7 — [Harper House Tavern](#) — Meriwether Lewis at Harpers Ferry

The Harpers House was near the end of a 20-year run as the only tavern in Harpers Ferry when Lewis arrived. Thomas Jefferson may have been among the first guests to stay here in 1783. If Lewis rented a room in 1803, he was among the last travelers to seek shelter here. — [Map](#) (db m18754)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — 6 — [Home of Joseph Perkins](#) — *Armory Superintendent* — Meriwether Lewis at Harpers Ferry

Armory Superintendent Joseph Perkins lived in a converted warehouse on this spot from 1801-1806. The day Lewis arrived, March 16, 1803, he hand-delivered a letter from the Secretary of War directing Perkins to provide "arms & iron work... with the least possible delay." Lewis may have stayed here while he was in Harpers Ferry. — [Map](#) (db m18804)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — 1 — [Home of Samuel Annin](#) — *Armory Paymaster* — Meriwether Lewis at Harpers Ferry

The U.S. Armory Paymaster's house stood here. Completed in 1802 as a home for the armory's senior administrator, this building was probably the best house in town when Meriwether Lewis arrived in 1803. Lewis may have stayed here and he certainly accounted for his supplies with Paymaster Samuel Annin. — [Map](#) (db m18662)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — 8 — [Jefferson Rock](#) — Meriwether Lewis at Harpers Ferry

Twenty years before Lewis came to town, his mentor, Thomas Jefferson, wrote about the view from this rock. Jefferson's comments on the landscape were published in *Notes on the State of Virginia*. That book provided a model for Lewis as he recorded his observations of the west. As Lewis gathered supplies here, did he follow in the footsteps of his mentor and take in this view? — [Map](#) (db m18791)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — 3 — [Large Arsenal Foundation](#) — Meriwether Lewis at Harpers Ferry

Completed in 1800, the 2 1/2-story, brick arsenal building stored weapons made for the security and survival of a young United States of America. Lewis procured 15 rifles from this stockpile. They were the first and most essential weapons his soldiers needed to survive on their wilderness journey. — [Map](#) (db m18752)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — [Lewis and Clark](#)

Meriwether Lewis arrived March 16, 1803. Oversaw building of collapsible iron framed, skin-clad boat and acquired supplies, tomahawks, and rifles. Left for Pennsylvania on April 18; returned July 7 to gather materials and left next day for Pittsburgh. Followed Ohio to Falls; met William Clark for trip to explore and study land, waterways, animal life, natural features and resources of West. — [Map](#) (db m2149)

West Virginia (Jefferson County), Harpers Ferry — 2 — [The Point](#) — Meriwether Lewis at Harpers Ferry

Today's view of the Potomac and Shenandoah rivers passing through the water gap in the Blue Ridge Mountains has changed little from Meriwether Lewis' view in 1803. Lewis hoped to find a similar, accessible trade route on rivers passing through the Rocky Mountains. — [Map](#) (db m18801)

West Virginia (Ohio County), Wheeling — [Lewis and Clark](#)

Meriwether Lewis arrived here on 7 September 1803 on first leg of trip to explore and study lands, natural features and resources, waterways, and animal life of West. Noted Fort Henry, procured second pirogue to transport supplies, picked up goods hauled from Pittsburgh and wrote to President Jefferson. Rested here 8 September and departed the following day down the Ohio River. — [Map](#) (db m2378)

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